METRIC
A-A-20092B
August 1, 2001
SUPERSEDING
A-A-20092A
May 26, 1989

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

STEAK SAUCE

The U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

1. SCOPE. This Commercial Item Description (CID) covers steak sauce, packed in commercially acceptable containers, suitable for use by Federal, State, local governments, and other interested parties.

2. PURCHASER NOTES.

2.1 Purchasers *shall specify* the following:

- Flavor(s) of steak sauce required (Sec. 3).
- When shelf life requirements are different than specified (Sec. 5.7).
- When analytical requirements are different than specified (Sec. 6.1).
- When analytical requirements need to be verified (Sec. 6.2).
- Manufacturer's/distributor's certification (Sec. 9.2) or USDA certification (Sec. 9.3).

2.2 Purchasers *may specify* the following:

- Manufacturer's quality assurance (Sec. 9.1 with 9.1.1) or (Sec. 9.1 with 9.1.2).
- Packaging requirements other than commercial (Sec. 10).

3. CLASSIFICATION. The steak sauce shall conform to the following flavors as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

Flavors.

Flavor I - Regular
Flavor II - Sweet/Tangy
Flavor III - Spicy

FSC 8950

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Flavor IV - Mesquite
Flavor V - Other

4. MANUFACTURER'S/DISTRIBUTOR'S NOTES. Manufacturer's/distributor's products *shall meet* the requirements of the:

- Salient characteristics (Sec. 5).
- Analytical requirements: *as specified by the purchaser* (Sec. 6).
- Manufacturer's/distributor's product assurance (Sec. 7).
- Regulatory requirements (Sec. 8).
- Quality assurance provisions: *as specified by the purchaser* (Sec. 9).
- Packaging requirements other than commercial: *as specified by the purchaser* (Sec.10).

5. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS.

5.1 Processing. The steak sauce shall be prepared in accordance with good manufacturing practices (21 CFR 110).

5.2 Ingredients. The steak sauce may contain ingredients, such as but not limited to; tomato puree (tomato paste and water), distilled vinegar, high fructose corn syrup, raisins, dates, molasses, salt, fruit, fruit concentrate, fruit peels, fruit juices, tamarind onion or onion powder, anchovies, hydrolyzed soy and corn protein, garlic or garlic powder, xanthan gum, potassium sorbate and sodium benzoate, natural flavor, shallots, caramel coloring, dehydrated parsley, and other ingredients.

5.3 Color and appearance. The steak sauce shall be a brown-colored liquid and have an appearance characteristic of the flavor specified.

5.4 Flavor and odor. The steak sauce shall possess a well-blended, sweet, acid, mellow, spicy, fruit flavor and odor characteristic of the flavor specified. There shall be no foreign flavors and odors such as, but not limited to: burnt, scorched, stale, or rancid.

5.5 Suspension. The steak sauce shall have finely ground suspended material evenly distributed throughout the liquid. It shall be a smooth suspension that shall not stratify or separate.

5.6 Foreign material. All ingredients shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and free from evidence of rodent or insect infestation.

5.7 Shelf life requirement. Unless otherwise specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the steak sauce shall have a minimum shelf life of 1 year from the time of production when stored unopened at a temperature of 4°C to 21°C (40°F to 70°F).

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6. ANALYTICAL REQUIREMENTS.

6.1 **Analytical requirements.** Unless otherwise specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the analytical requirements for the steak sauce shall be as follows:

Test	Requirement
Titratable acidity (as acetic acid)	1.5 percent to 4.2 percent
Salt (NaCl)	2.0 percent to 5.5 percent
Soluble Solids	24 percent to 50 percent
Consistency	Not less than 6.5 or more than 14.5 centimeters in 30 seconds at 20°C (68°F) ± 1°C (1.8°F)

6.2 **Product verification.** When USDA verification of analytical requirements is specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the following procedures will be followed.

6.2.1 **Sampling procedures.** USDA inspection service will select the number of product containers based on USDA inspection service sampling procedures and plans.

6.3 **Analytical testing.** When specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the analyses shall be made in accordance with the following methods from the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International:

Test	Method
Titratable Acidity	920.174
Salt (as NaCl)	941.13
Soluble Solids	932.12
Consistency	Bostwick Consistometer

6.4 **Test results.** The test results for titratable acidity, salt, and soluble solids shall be reported to the nearest 0.1 percent. Any result not conforming to the analytical requirement shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

7. **MANUFACTURER'S/DISTRIBUTOR'S PRODUCT ASSURANCE.** The manufacturer/ distributor shall certify that the steak sauce provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this CID, conform to the their own specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and be the same steak sauce offered for sale in the commercial market. The purchaser reserves the right to require proof of conformance.

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8. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS. The delivered steak sauce shall comply with all applicable Federal, State, and local mandatory requirements and regulations relating to the preparation, packaging, labeling, storage, distribution, and sale of steak sauce within the commercial marketplace. Delivered steak sauce shall comply with all applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder.

9. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS. *Purchaser shall specify 9.2 or 9.3; purchaser may specify 9.1 with 9.1.1 or 9.1 with 9.1.2.*

9.1 Manufacturer's quality assurance. When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the product manufacturer shall be required to provide evidence, by certificate, that the manufacturing plant has undertaken one of the following quality assurance measures within 12 months prior to providing a bid, or no later than 10 business days from the date of awarding of the contract. Failure to provide this documentation within the proper time frame may result in the contract being terminated for cause.

9.1.1 Plant systems audit. A plant systems audit (PSA) conducted by USDA, Agricultural Marketing Service (AMS), or another audit performed by a third party auditing service is required within 12 months prior to the date of the awarding of the contract. *(An AMS PSA verifies the manufacturer's capability to produce products in a clean, sanitary environment in accordance with Title 21 Code of Federal Regulations Part 110 - Current Good Manufacturing Practice in Manufacturing, Packing, or Holding Human Food, and verifies that the manufacturer has in place an internal quality assurance program. The AMS PSA determines the manufacturer's ability to produce under this CID, if the products of interest are identified at the time of the PSA.)*

9.1.2 Plant survey. A plant survey conducted by USDA, AMS, or another survey performed by a third party auditing service is required within 12 months prior to the date of the awarding of the contract. *(An AMS plant survey audit verifies that, at the time of the survey, the manufacturer produces products in a clean, sanitary environment in accordance with Title 21 Code of Federal Regulations Part 110 - Current Good Manufacturing Practice in Manufacturing, Packing, or Holding Human Food.)*

9.2 Manufacturer's/distributor's certification. When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, the manufacturer/distributor will certify that the finished steak sauce distributed meets or exceeds the requirements of this CID.

9.3 USDA certification. When required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order that product quality and acceptability or both be determined, the Processed Products Branch (PPB), Fruit and Vegetable Programs (FVP), AMS, USDA, shall be the certifying program. PPB inspectors shall certify the quality and acceptability of the steak sauce in accordance with PPB procedures which include selecting random samples of the packaged steak sauce, evaluating the

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samples for conformance with the salient characteristics of this CID and other contractual requirements, and documenting the findings on official PPB score sheets and/or certificates. In addition, when required in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, PPB inspectors will examine the steak sauce for conformance to the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers in effect on the date of the solicitation.

10. PACKAGING. Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and case marking shall be commercial unless otherwise specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order.

11. USDA INSPECTION NOTES. When Section 9.3 is specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order, USDA certification shall include evaluation of the quality and condition of samples of packaged steak sauce, and compliance with requirements in the following areas:

- Salient characteristics (Sec. 5).
- Analytical requirements *when specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order* (Sec. 6.1). When USDA analytical testing is specified, PPB inspection personnel shall select samples and submit them to the USDA, Science and Technology Programs (S&TP) laboratory for analysis.
- Packaging requirements (Sec. 10 or as specified in the solicitation, contract, or purchase order).

12. REFERENCE NOTES.

12.1 USDA certification contact. For USDA certification, contact the **Branch Chief, PPB, FVP, AMS, USDA, STOP 0247, 1400 Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250-0247 telephone (202) 720-4693, Fax (202) 690-1527, or via E-mail: james.rodeheaver@usda.gov.**

12.2 Analytical testing and technical information. For USDA technical information on analytical testing, contact the **Branch Chief, Technical Service Branch, S&TP, AMS, USDA, STOP 0272, 1400 Independence Avenue, SW, Washington, DC 20250-0272, telephone (202) 690-0621, or via E-mail: anita.okrend@usda.gov.**

12.3 Sources of documents.

12.3.1 Source of information for nongovernmental document is as follows:

Copies of the Official Methods of Analysis of the AOAC International may be obtained from: **AOAC International, 481 North Frederick Avenue, Suite 500, Gaithersburg, MD 20877, telephone (301) 924-7077. Internet address: http://www.aoac.org.**

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12.3.2 Sources of information for governmental documents are as follows:

Applicable provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act are contained in 21 CFR Parts 1 to 199. This document may be purchased from: **Superintendent of Documents, ATTN: New Orders, P.O. Box 371954, Pittsburgh, PA 15250-7954. Credit card (MasterCard or Visa) purchases may be made by calling the Superintendent of Documents (202) 512-1803 or on the Internet at: http://www.nara.gov/fedreg.**

Copies of this CID and the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers, and beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this CID are available from and/or provided to: **Head, Food Quality Assurance Staff, FVP, AMS, USDA, STOP 0243, 1400 Independence Ave., SW, Washington, DC 20250-0243, telephone (202) 720-9939, Fax (202) 690-0102, via E-mail: FQAStaff@usda.gov or on the Internet at: http://www.ams.usda.gov/fv/fvqual.htm.**

Military activities should submit requests for copies of this CID to: **Standardization Documents Order Desk, Document Automation And Production Service, 700 Robbins Avenue, Building 4D, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.**

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity:

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Navy - SA
Air Force - 35

Review Activities

Army - MD, QM
Navy - MC
DLA - SS

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

DOJ - BOP
HHS - NIH, IHS
USDA - FV
VA - OSS

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

USDA - FV

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